

“But we can’t just turn around and go back home,” Andrea complained. “We’ve already come this far. Let’s go on, please.”

Bill was in no mood to discuss anything objectively, and when he saw the hurt on Andrea’s face, he surrendered. “Okay,” he said. “If you’re willing, I am too. But let’s get going. We’ll just make it back in time.”

Andrea had literally jumped out of her seat and was headed toward the door when Bill asked, “Do you have any cash, Andrea? I’m a little short to pay the bill.”

Andrea dug into her purse and found about \$3.00 in change. She asked the waitress, “Can I pay for the meal with my credit card?”

“Sorry,” the waitress replied, “we don’t take credit cards. The boss says they cost too much to process.”

So Bill paid the check with what they could scrape together, and they headed toward New Jersey. Several hours later they entered New Jersey and encountered their first toll bridge. In the meantime, their periodic stops had exhausted their small cash reserve. The tollgate attendant told them that they would either have to pay the toll or turn around and go back.

“Can we pay the toll with a credit card?” Andrea asked.

“No, you can’t, Miss,” he answered. “Look, kids, the toll is only \$1.10. Are you telling me you don’t even have that much on you?”

Looking a little sheepish, Bill replied, “I’m afraid not. You see, we were planning to get married in Virginia, but when we found out we had to wait two days, we decided to drive up here instead. We have to be back in school Monday.”

“Well, good luck. But I don’t think you’re getting off to a good start this way. Exactly how much do you have?”

“About fifty-six cents,” Andrea said in a whisper.

“Tell you what I’ll do,” the attendant said in a stern voice. “Give me what you have, and I’ll put in the difference. You’re holding up traffic.”

“Oh, thank you, sir,” was Andrea’s reply.